

UNITED NATIONS NATIONS UNIES
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026

Fellowship Award Specification

International Organization for Migration
Country Office, Côte d'Ivoire

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Migration Management

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr. David Preux
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Chief of Mission
<u>Name of the Direct Supervisor</u>	To be confirmed
<u>Title of the Direct Supervisor:</u>	Programme Support Officer

3. Background information

Established in 1951, IOM is a Related Organization of the United Nations, and as the leading UN agency in the field of migration, works closely with governmental, intergovernmental and non-governmental partners. IOM is dedicated to promoting humane and orderly migration for the benefit of all. It does so by providing services and advice to governments and migrants.

Côte d'Ivoire became an IOM Member State in June 2000. IOM Côte d'Ivoire falls under the purview of the IOM Regional Office for Central and West Africa in Dakar, Senegal. The Mission implements programmes in the fields of migration governance, migrant protection, return and reintegration as well as labour mobility, protection, border management, counter-trafficking, climate change adaptation, and peacebuilding.

In recent years, IOM Côte d'Ivoire has become a key partner for Italy by contributing to shared objectives such as promoting regular migration pathways, job creation, human capital development, and sustainable management of mobility. The Mission is also engaged in dialogue with the African Development Bank (AfDB) and other institutions to promote investment in migration-related initiatives.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

- Support IOM Côte d'Ivoire in strengthening collaboration and partnerships with National authorities and development actors.
- Assist in the follow-up and operationalization of the bilateral agreement on migration and related policy frameworks between Côte d'Ivoire and Italy, including monitoring progress.
- Contribute to the development and implementation of initiatives particularly in areas related to skills mobility pathways (SMP) toward Italy, prevention of irregular migration, and border governance:
- Assist in baseline assessments and preparatory activities for pathways between Italy and Côte d'Ivoire.
- Contribute to the design and implementation of projects addressing root causes of irregular migration, including employment creation, youth engagement, sensitization campaigns and local development.
- Support border governance initiatives aimed at strengthening migration management capacities at strategic border points.
- Provide analytical support to identify synergies among IOM Côte d'Ivoire's programmes, ensuring coherence with national priorities and IOM's strategic frameworks.
- Support resource mobilization and donor engagement efforts by preparing briefing materials, background notes, and talking points.
- Facilitate liaison and information exchange between IOM Côte d'Ivoire, the Embassy of Italy, the Italian Agency for Development Cooperation (AICS), the Italian Chamber of Commerce in Côte d'Ivoire and other private sector actors, such as diaspora networks, to promote coherent approaches and coordination on migration-related initiatives.
- Contribute to advocacy and partnership efforts with the AfDB, identifying opportunities for investment (e.g. youth employability, mobility, and resilience).
- Support IOM representation in Inter-Agency meetings (UNCT, OMT, UN – Government cooperation framework meeting preparations)
- Assist in organizing bilateral missions, technical exchanges, and visibility events involving Italian institutions and private sector actors, in line with IOM's Private Sector Engagement Strategy.
- Contribute to communication and visibility efforts by drafting content (social media posts, newsletter inputs, press releases) on migration.
- Support the monitoring and evaluation (M&E) of IOM activities by compiling data, documenting results, and highlighting good practices and lessons learned.

Through this assignment, the Fellow will gain valuable experience in:

- Multilateral cooperation and donor relations within the context of international development;
- Programme development and results-based management in the field of migration;

- Coordination and dialogue between government institutions, international organizations, and the private sector;
- Strategic communications and visibility in an international cooperation setting.
- Operations related to IOM's mandate such as providing direct assistance to migrants, organizing capacity building events and policy meetings.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree in International Relations, Political Sciences, Migration and Development Studies or other relevant studies.

Work experience

- Demonstrated interest and/or experience in relevant issues such as migration, displacement, humanitarian assistance, development.
- Previous experience in working in a multicultural environment, (i.e. internship) would be highly regarded.
- Practical experience of how-to multi-task, prioritize and work independently; ability to work with tight deadlines.

Languages

Excellent command of English and French.

Other skills

- Excellent drafting skills and ability to produce reports, briefing notes, and project documents in French;
- Strong organizational and coordination skills, with attention to detail and ability to manage multiple priorities under tight deadlines;
- Proven interpersonal and communication skills, with the ability to work effectively and harmoniously in a multicultural environment;
- Analytical skills and ability to synthesize complex information related to migration management, international cooperation, and development;
- Good understanding of project development and results-based management (RBM) principles;
- Strong IT and digital communication skills, including proficiency in Microsoft Office applications (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Publisher, SharePoint) and familiarity with online collaboration tools (Teams, OneDrive, Outlook);
- Knowledge of data collection and visualization tools (e.g. Excel dashboards, or similar) would be an advantage;
- Ability to adapt quickly to institutional procedures, show initiative, and work both independently and as part of a team.

Competencies

1. Professionalism

- Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of migration management, international cooperation, and programme development.
- Shows knowledge of results-based management, donor relations, and project reporting.
- Displays sound judgment in analyzing complex issues related to migration, protection, and policy implementation.

2. Teamwork

- Works collaboratively with colleagues from diverse cultural and professional backgrounds to achieve organizational goals.
- Supports a cooperative working environment by sharing knowledge, information, and expertise.
- Builds and maintains effective working relationships with counterparts, partners, and stakeholders, including government institutions, diplomatic missions, civil society, and the private sector.

3. Communication

- Speaks and writes clearly and effectively in French and Italian; knowledge of English is an asset.
- Produces concise and well-structured reports, briefings, and donor communications.
- Effectively conveys technical and policy information to different audiences, including Italian partners, IOM staff, and external stakeholders.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Facilitate **international cooperation and donor relations**, particularly engaging development partners, and international financial institutions such as the AfDB.
- Better articulate how Migration governance, Policy and cooperation initiatives can influence migration dynamics in Sub-Saharan African, particularly to and from Côte d'Ivoire.
- **Draft, assess, and develop project proposals, concept notes, and reports** in line with UN results-based management (RBM) framework and donor requirements.
- Apply **results-based management and monitoring & evaluation approaches** to migration programming.
- Assist in the **design, implementation, and monitoring of programmes** on migration management, border governance, migrant protection, and regular pathways, including skills mobility initiatives.
- Acquire practical skills in **liaising and coordinating with diplomatic missions, international agencies, the private sector, and diaspora networks**, as well as organizing and documenting bilateral coordination and visibility events.
- Develop a strong understanding of **IOM's mandate and strategic frameworks**, including the IOM Strategic Vision, the Global Compact for Migration, and Côte d'Ivoire's national priorities.
- Gain experience in **communication, advocacy, visibility, and partnership-building**, including drafting materials highlighting project impacts and supporting policy or investment advocacy.
- Enhance **analytical, coordination, and operational skills** through participation in multisectoral and interinstitutional meetings, capacity-building events, and policy dialogues.
- Build **professional networks** with key stakeholders in migration and development across government, private sector, civil society, and international organizations.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

The Fellow will work under the direct supervision of the Programme Support Officer and in close coordination with relevant units within IOM Côte d'Ivoire, including the Programme and resource management units. The supervision will provide both technical guidance and opportunities for professional development.

An initial briefing will be organized at the start of the assignment to introduce the Fellow to IOM Côte d'Ivoire's mandate, strategic priorities, mission activities, and the Italy–EU–Côte d'Ivoire cooperation portfolio. The briefing will also clarify the fellowship's objectives, expected outputs, and reporting lines. A work plan outlining key activities will be jointly developed with the direct supervisor. Regular weekly meetings will be held with the Programme Support Officer to review progress, provide feedback, and

address challenges encountered during implementation. In addition, monthly check-ins will be scheduled with the Chief of Mission. The Fellow will also participate in team meetings, cross-unit coordination discussions, and relevant external engagements with government counterparts, operational and institutional partners, as well as private sector stakeholders to ensure full integration into the Mission's work.

Mid-term and final performance assessments will be conducted to review learning achievements and professional development. The Fellow will be encouraged to take initiative, propose innovative ideas, and actively contribute to the achievement of programme objectives. Throughout the fellowship, the supervisor will ensure continuous mentoring, facilitate access to learning resources—including IOM's online training platform and relevant contacts—and provide constructive feedback to strengthen the Fellow's analytical, coordination, and communication skills. Supervision will therefore combine on-the-job learning, mentoring, and participation in project and donor coordination meetings to ensure an enriching and comprehensive capacity-building experience.

8. Living conditions in the country

Côte d'Ivoire is a dynamic and fast-developing country located in West Africa, known for its warm hospitality, cultural diversity, and vibrant economy. The Fellow will be based in Abidjan, the country's economic capital and one of the region's most cosmopolitan cities.

The city hosts a large international community, including staff from the United Nations, African Development Bank, embassies, and international NGOs. Essential services such as transportation, banking, and internet connectivity are readily available. Côte d'Ivoire enjoys a relatively stable political and security environment, and Ivorians are known for being welcoming and friendly.

While living in Côte d'Ivoire requires the usual precautions associated with large urban areas, overall living conditions are good and allow for a comfortable and enriching professional and cultural experience.